

Don Polistico

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Summary

Senior product designer with 15+ years in streaming video and consumer electronics, carried through three acquisitions: Boxee to Samsung, VHX to Vimeo, and Vimeo to Bending Spoons. I design cross-platform OTT products, from 10-foot TV interfaces to creator monetization tools, and the design systems that hold them together. Recent focus on emerging technologies, including holographic hardware ecosystems at Looking Glass, decentralized social protocols (blockchain, web3) at Primitives.xyz, and AI-driven design workflows that shorten the path from design to shipped code.

Experience

Independent practice | Designer | Brooklyn, NY | June 2025 – Present

- **Building AI-driven design workflows** with agentic tools (Google Antigravity, Claude Code), focused on machine-readable design infrastructure that reduces friction in the design-to-engineering handoff.
- **Designed and shipped personal AI products end to end**, including a local assistant running on dedicated hardware and a personal knowledge vault for organizing research and inspiration.

[Vimeo](#) | **Senior Product Designer | New York, NY | June 2016 – June 2025**

- **Led design for Vimeo Streaming** (OTT) across **11+ platforms** (web, iOS, Android, tvOS, Android TV, Roku, Fire TV, Samsung, LG), a product powering **\$429M+ in annual creator revenue** and **5,000+ launched channels**.
- **Designed the App Builder 0→1**, a no-code publishing tool built on a modular template system with platform compliance (Apple, Roku, Amazon, Google) built in by default; it became the primary driver of creator acquisition.
- Defined interaction patterns for the Vimeo player, balancing craft with technical feasibility across devices supporting **millions of daily plays**.
- Carried the product through three company-defining shifts: the VHX integration after the 2016 acquisition, the pivot from creator tool to B2B platform, and the Bending Spoons acquisition.
- Built and maintained the shared design system (components, patterns, documentation) for web and mobile as the product surface scaled.

[VHX](#) | **Senior Product Designer | Brooklyn, NY | October 2015 – May 2016**

- Designed direct-to-consumer video distribution tools for independent creators, focusing on payment flows and audience management.
- Partnered with developers to launch custom OTT streaming apps, establishing the foundational patterns later adopted by Vimeo.

[Samsung](#) | **Senior Product Designer | New York, NY | July 2013 – November 2015**

- Designed and prototyped multi-screen user experiences for Samsung's Smart TV ecosystem and connected devices.
- Collaborated with global engineering teams to integrate Boxee's software interface into Samsung's Smart TV ecosystem and next-generation remotes.

[Boxee](#) | **Designer | New York, NY | July 2010 – July 2013**

- Designed the **0→1 Cloud DVR** experience (recording, series scheduling, conflict resolution) and social TV features, inventing 10-foot UI patterns years before tvOS or Android TV conventions existed.
- Designed the out-of-box experience (under 5 minutes from unboxing to first content) and contributed to the dual-sided QWERTY remote, packaging, and retail launch materials.

Contract & consulting

[Looking Glass](#) | Senior Product Designer (Contract) | Brooklyn, NY | 2022 – 2024

- Defined interaction models for proprietary holographic displays, creating a design system that bridged 2D desktop workflows with 3D spatial visualization.
- Collaborated closely with graphics engineers to prototype and ship Unity-based applications, ensuring visual fidelity across multiple hardware generations.

[Primitives.xyz](#) | Senior Product Designer (Contract) | New York, NY | 2022 – 2024

- Designed the end-to-end 'Creator App' for iOS and mobile web while optimizing the core web experience for a decentralized social sharing protocol.
- Partnered with the founding team to translate complex Web3 primitives into intuitive mobile interfaces, focusing on onboarding and content creation tools.

[Recount Media](#) | Senior Product Designer (Contract) | New York, NY | 2020

- Designed mobile-first video discovery features for the political news platform, optimizing the "watch" flow to increase viewer retention.
- Partnered with editorial and engineering teams to rapidly prototype and launch new content formats for daily news cycles.

[One Month](#) | Designer (Contract) | New York, NY | 2013 – 2014

- Collaborated with the founder during the Y Combinator (S13) incubator to design the MVP interface and translate technical curriculums into intuitive user flows, helping the team secure early traction and seed funding.

Skills & Tools

- **Tools:** Figma, FigJam, Claude Code, Google Antigravity, Glif, AI prototyping and agentic workflows, design tokens, prototyping in code.
- **Platforms:** iOS, Android, responsive web, tvOS, Android TV, Roku, Fire TV, Samsung Tizen, XBOX, LG webOS
- **Craft:** Design systems, 10-foot UI, interaction design, information architecture, monetization and payment flows, usability testing, user interviews, accessibility.
- **Certification:** [AI for UX Design](#) | Coursework completed in 2025 on leveraging AI tools for modern design workflows.

Education

[Maryland Institute College of Art \(MICA\)](#) | BFA in Design

- Winner of the Stempel Thesis Prize Award for exemplary senior thesis work. <https://vimeo.com/donosaur/script>

[Johns Hopkins University](#) | Engineering Coursework

Additional

Owner-operator of a two-unit residential building in Brooklyn (repair/maintenance/renovation management, tenant relations, P&L).